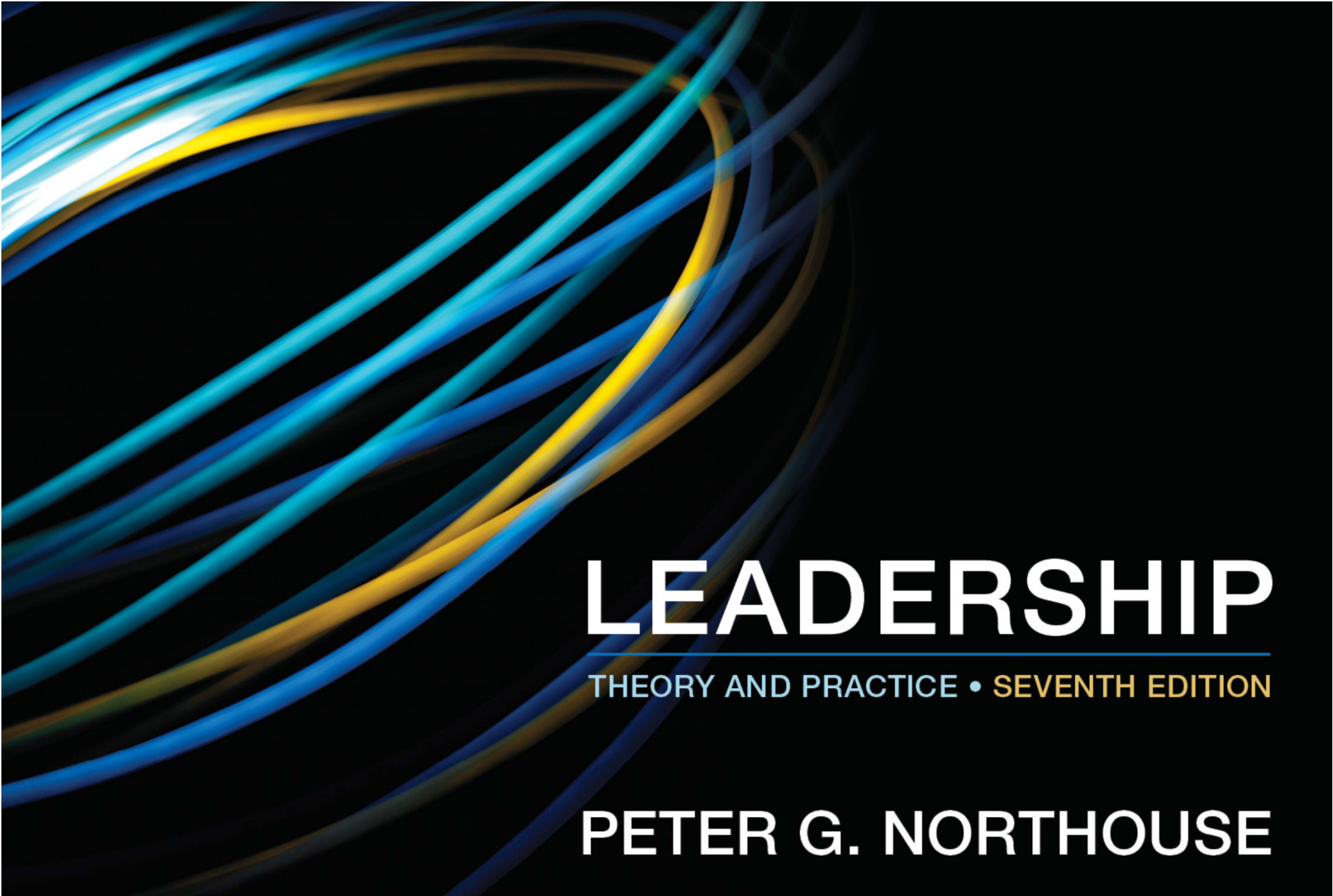




LEADERSHIP

THEORY AND PRACTICE • SEVENTH EDITION

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Chapter 2: Trait Approach

Overview

- ✦ Great Person Theories
- ✦ Historical Shifts in Trait Perspective
- ✦ What Traits Differentiate Leaders From Nonleaders?
- ✦ How Does the Trait Approach Work?

Great Person Theories

Trait Approach: one of the first systematic attempts to study leadership

- ✦ **“Great Man” Theories (early 1900s)**
 - ◆ Focused on identifying innate qualities and characteristics possessed by great social, political, & military leaders

Historical Shifts in Trait Perspective

Table 2.1 Studies of Leadership Traits and Characteristics

Stogdill (1948)	Mann (1959)	Stogdill (1974)	Lord, DeVader, and Alliger (1986)	Kirkpatrick and Locke (1991)	Zaccaro, Kemp, and Bader (2004)
intelligence	intelligence	achievement	intelligence	drive	cognitive abilities
alertness	masculinity	persistence	masculinity	motivation	extraversion
insight	adjustment	insight	dominance	integrity	conscientiousness
responsibility	dominance	initiative		confidence	emotional stability
initiative	extraversion	self-confidence		cognitive	openness
persistence	conservatism	responsibility		ability	agreeableness
self-confidence		cooperativeness		task	motivation
sociability		tolerance		knowledge	social intelligence
		influence			self-monitoring
		sociability			emotional intelligence
					problem solving

SOURCES: Adapted from "The Bases of Social Power," by J. R. P. French, Jr., and B. Raven, 1962, in D. Cartwright (Ed.), *Group Dynamics: Research and Theory* (pp. 259–269), New York: Harper and Row; Zaccaro, Kemp, & Bader (2004).

Major Leadership Traits

Traits to possess or cultivate if one seeks to be perceived by others as a leader:

- ✦ **Intelligence** – Verbal, perceptual, and reasoning capabilities. Ex. Steve Jobs
- ✦ **Self-Confidence** – Certainty about one's competencies and skills. Ex. Steve Jobs
- ✦ **Determination** – Desire to get the job done (i.e., initiative, persistence, drive). Ex. Dr. Paul Farmer

Major Leadership Traits

Traits to possess or cultivate if one seeks to be perceived by others as a leader:

- ✦ **Integrity** – The quality of honesty and trustworthiness. Ex. Character Counts! program
- ✦ **Sociability** – Leader's inclination to seek out pleasant social relationships. Ex. Michael Hughes, university president

5-Factor Personality Model & Leadership

Table 2.3 Big Five Personality Factors

Neuroticism	The tendency to be depressed, anxious, insecure, vulnerable, and hostile
Extraversion	The tendency to be sociable and assertive and to have positive energy
Openness	The tendency to be informed, creative, insightful, and curious
Agreeableness	The tendency to be accepting, conforming, trusting, and nurturing
Conscientiousness	The tendency to be thorough, organized, controlled, dependable, and decisive

5-Factor Personality Model & Leadership

*Big Five & Leadership Study Using Meta-Analysis
(Judge et al., 2002)*

Results – a strong relationship between personality traits and leadership

- ✦ ***Extraversion*** – factor most strongly associated with leadership
 - ◆ Most important trait of effective leaders
- ✦ ***Conscientiousness*** – second most related factor
- ✦ ***Openness*** – next most related
- ✦ ***Low Neuroticism***
- ✦ ***Agreeableness*** – only weakly related to leadership

Emotional Intelligence & Leadership

Definition

Ability to perceive and:

- ✦ apply emotions to life's tasks
- ✦ reason/understand emotions
- ✦ express emotions
- ✦ use emotions to facilitate thinking
- ✦ manage emotions within oneself and relationships

Underlying Premise

- ✦ people who are more sensitive to their emotions & their impact on others will be more effective leaders

Different Ways to Measure EQ

- ✦ **MSCEIT:** EQ as a set of mental abilities
 - ✦ to perceive, facilitate, understand, and manage emotion
- ✦ **Goleman (1995, 1998):** EQ as a set of personal and social competencies
 - ✦ self-awareness, confidence, self-regulation, conscientiousness, and motivation
- ✦ **Shankman & Allen (2002):** EQ as awareness of three aspects of leadership
 - ✦ context, self, and others

How Does the Trait Approach Work?

- ✦ Focus of Trait Approach
- ✦ Strengths
- ✦ Criticisms
- ✦ Application

Focus of Trait Approach

Leader

- ✦ Focuses ***exclusively*** on leader
 - ◆ What traits leaders exhibit
 - ◆ Who has these traits

Personality Assessments

- ✦ Organizations use personality assessments to find “right” people
 - ◆ ***Assumption*** - will increase organizational effectiveness
 - ◆ Specify characteristics/traits for specific positions
 - Personality assessment measures for “fit”
 - Instruments: LTQ, Myers-Briggs

Strengths

- ✦ Intuitively ***appealing***
 - ◆ Perception that leaders are different in that they possess special traits
 - ◆ People “need” to view leaders as gifted
- ✦ ***Credibility*** due to a century of research support
- ✦ Highlights ***leadership component*** in the leadership process
 - ◆ Deeper level understanding of how leader/personality is related to leadership process
- ✦ Provides ***benchmarks*** for what to look for in a leader

Criticisms

- ✦ Fails to ***delimit*** a definitive list of leadership traits
 - ◆ Endless lists have emerged
- ✦ Doesn't take into account ***situational effects***
 - ◆ Leaders in one situation may not be leaders in another situation
- ✦ List of most important leadership traits is ***highly subjective***
 - ◆ Much subjective experience & observations serve as basis for identified leadership traits
- ✦ Research fails to look at traits in relationship to leadership ***outcomes***
- ✦ Not useful for ***training & development***

Application

- ✦ Provides direction as to which traits are good to have if one aspires to a leadership position
- ✦ Through various tests and questionnaires, individuals can determine whether they have the select leadership traits and can pinpoint their strengths and weaknesses
- ✦ Can be used by managers to assess where they stand within their organization and what is needed to strengthen their position

Leadership Traits

- **Intelligence**
- **Self-Confidence**
- **Determination**
- **Integrity**
- **Sociability**